Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers

CONSTITUTION

LAST REVISED 08/2024

Article I – Name of Organization

Section 1. The official name of this organization is Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers, Cornell SHPE Student Chapter Campus Activities and University Relations have approved it. The name follows the Cornell University Policy 4.10 on Student Organization Branding.

Section 2. This organization is also called **SHPE** and will be the official acronym.

Article II –Mission, Purpose, Aims of Organization

Section 1. The purpose of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers** shall be to increase the participation of Hispanic professionals and college students in the fields of engineering, technology, science, and math.

Section 2. The goals of this organization are to assist presently enrolled Hispanics/Latino students in their endeavors towards a STEM education, professional development, community outreach, and service to fellow peers by:

- Providing academic support through mentorship, academic resources, and events.
- Providing members with the essential information conveyed through workshops, meetings, and presentations to prepare members for the workforce or further education.
- Leading events and projects geared towards servicing individuals in the community at large and strengthening ties with the Latino community.
- Attaining corporate sponsorship and developing/maintaining career and corporate contacts.

Section 3. This organization is associated with the following local, state, national, or international organization: **Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers Inc.**

Article III – Membership Requirements and Limitations (This section is MANDATORY but can be determined by the organization in areas not highlighted in green.)

Section 1. Membership eligibility.

a. The organization shall consist of **UNDERGRADUATE and GRADUATE STUDENTS** of Cornell University who are interested in the purpose of the **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers** and who shall be approved by the Officers.
b. Members of registered student organizations must be registered, matriculated full-time students at their respective Cornell University campuses (i.e., Ithaca, Geneva, NYC Tech). Part-time students, non-matriculated students, students on a leave of absence, or students who are abroad may not serve as officers, eboard,

and/or voting members of student organizations. It is the responsibility of the Advisor to collaborate with the President to ensure that all officers are full-time students on their campus. If one of your officers has a change in status that will require them to step down from their position, please contact the Campus Activities Office. General members may be students, faculty, staff, or community members.

c. **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers** complies with Cornell University Policy 6.4 of Prohibited Bias, Discrimination, Harassment, and Sexual and Related Misconduct. This policy is also outlined in the Big Red Guidebook.

Section 2. General membership expectations.

a. Members are expected to assist with the planning, advertising, and implementing of events hosted by the organization.
b. Members hold voting power during elections and when items are brought up to the organization to vote on. Their vote holds the same power as an Officer's vote.
c. Members are invited to all social events hosted by the organization.

Section 3. New member recruitment.

a. Recruitment for **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers** occurs at the beginning of each semester.
b. The organization recruits through ClubFest, social media, quarter cards, etc...
c. Membership is granted based on **interest**.

Section 4. The Officers reserve the right to remove any member (based on the unanimous decision of the Officers and Advisor) through the following grounds:

a. Violation of rules and regulations outlined in the Cornell Student Policies and/or Student Code of Conduct.
b. Failure to uphold the provisions of the constitution and bylaws.
c. Does not act in the best interests of the organization and/or is engaged in activity jeopardizing the organization's existence.

Article IV – Student Code of Conduct

Section 1. All members must follow local, state, and federal laws, Cornell University rules, and the organization's constitution at all functions.

Section 2. All members will abide by Cornell University Policies, specifically policy 6.4: Prohibited Bias, Discrimination, Harassment, and Sexual and Related Misconduct.

Section 3. In case of a violation and/or an active University investigation, the following are options *(Note: Many University investigations are confidential, and there is no obligation for the University office to share information about a case)*:

a. Members involved in an active University investigation may receive a temporary suspension or limited membership as determined by a unanimous decision of the Officers and Advisor.

b. Members found violating university policy may be permanently removed as members as determined by a unanimous decision of Officers and Advisors.

Article V – Executive Board of Officers

Section 1. Elected Officers.

a. The elected officers in **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers** shall be the President, Vice President, Treasurer, and any other officers listed in **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers**'s Standing Rules, Policies, and Procedures.

Section 2. President. The President shall:

a. Coordinate all functions and activities of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers.**
b. Chair all General Membership and Executive Board meetings.
c. Ensure that **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers**'s activities and members follow all Cornell University policies.
d. Secure **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers**'s registration with Cornell University each year.
e. Maintain open communication with each officer and faculty/staff advisor.
f. Install and remove all appointed officers with the approval of the Executive Board.
g. Serve as a non-official member of each committee.
h. Act as a spokesperson for the organization.
i. Organize and run an officer transition and education program for new officers.
j. Maintain contact with and solicit participation from organization advisors.
k. Seek out new advisors, if needed, and acquaint them with the organization's history, traditions, and procedures.
l. Coordinate with advisor to plan Cornell SHPE attendance at the SHPE National Conference.

Section 3. Vice President. The Vice President shall:

a. Serve as Executive Vice President of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers.**

b. Ensure that all the organization's activities and members follow all Cornell University policies.
c. Maintain accurate records of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers's** Membership.
d. Maintain records of participation in events for each Member.
e. Oversee the review of each Member's requirements.
f. Endeavor to improve **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers's** retention of its Members.
g. The Vice President will assume the role if the President cannot perform their duties for a meeting, event, or other purpose.

Section 4. Secretary. The Secretary shall:

a. Coordinate the communicative functions of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers.**
b. Record minutes of and attendance at each General Membership and Executive Board meeting.
c. Appoint scribes to record minutes in committee meetings as needed.
d. Be responsible for reserving rooms for all social events.
e. The Secretary will assume the role if the Vice President cannot perform their duties for a meeting, event, or other purpose.

Section 5. Treasurer. The Treasurer shall:

a. Collect and distribute all monies of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers.**
b. Keep clear records of all of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers**'s financial activity.
c. Provide regular reports to the General Membership on the organization's finances.
d. Oversee the organization's budget, including allocating funds and keeping records of previous budgets.
e. Prepare and submit applications for funding to the SAFC or any other necessary organization.
f. The Treasurer will assume the role if the Secretary cannot perform their duties for a meeting, event, or other purpose.
g. Assist the President in planning and budgeting for the SHPE national conference.
h. Report spending to the club's advisor monthly.
i. Make purchases for events such as food or materials.

Section 6. Web Development Chair. The Web Development Chair shall:

a. Manage all aspects of the web development team (recruitment, task management, etc.)
b. Update the organization's website with current board members and information
c. Document changes to the website and facilitate onboarding of future web developers

Section 7. Corporate Chair. The Corporate Chair shall:

a. Manage the corporate email by responding to any inquiries about events or sponsorships.
b. Coordinate with Board Members to choose a date and time for events.
c. Maintain communication with company sponsorships about events.
d. Reach out to potential sponsors with our updated corporate sponsorship packet.

Section 8. Community Outreach Chair. The Community Outreach Chair shall:

a. Coordinate with local organizations to set up STEM events benefitting the local Ithaca community.
b. Plan logistics for Dia de Ciencias, an annual service event hosted in collaboration with GIAC.
c. Maintain relationships with community partners and provide member support for their events as appropriate.
d. Attend the annual Cornell Service Fair to meet new and returning community partners looking for volunteers.

Section 9. Publicity Chair. The Publicity Chair shall:

a. Maintain an active presence on our social media accounts (Instagram, Slack, etc.).
b. Design advertisement flyers and posts to be distributed for every event the club hosts.
c. Promote club events on social media and coordinate with Cornell Engineering for promotion on their socials.

Section 10. Relations Chair. The Relations Chair shall

a. Develop events with and facilitate collaboration with other student organizations
b. Act as an avenue of communication with other organizations

Section 11. Chapter Development Chair. The Chapter Development chair shall:

a. Manage communication with general body members for event ideas, voting, and general feedback.
b. Share ideas and feedback with Board Members on any information and communication received from the general body during the Board Meetings.

c. Document feedback from events and maintain a list of potential future events.
d. Inform general body members of upcoming events during general body meetings.
e. Maintain a Google calendar of events shared with the members of **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers.**

Section 12. Academic Chair. The Academic Chair shall:

a. Organize professional development workshops including but not limited to resume workshops, cover letter workshops, and summer opportunities sessions.
b. Plan events focusing on exam prep, collaborative learning, and study tips throughout the year.
c. Spread the word about professional and academic development opportunities available to students on and off campus.

Section 13. Freshman Representative. The Freshman Representative shall:

a. Advertise our organization to the freshman population.
b. Plan and gather ideas for events involving freshmen to build a relationship with potential new members.
c. Act as a spokesperson for the freshmen class, aiming to avoid conflicts such as prelims with events and general body meetings.

Section 14. Term of Service.

a. No individual shall hold a specific position as Officer for more than **five** semesters.
b. Grounds for removal of an officer include:
    i. Violation of rules and regulations outlined in the Student Code of Conduct.
    ii. Failure to uphold the provisions of the constitution and bylaws

Section 15. Elections.

At the end of each academic year, **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers** may or may not hold elections, depending on the percentage of members who wish to.

a. If more than forty-nine percent of members wish to do the latter, members will vote by paper ballot or electronic alternative.
b. All current officers must rerun at the end of their year-long term.
c. Members running for positions may give a speech before voting takes place.
d. A majority vote determines elections.
e. The President and Vice President will not vote in the election unless there is a tie, in which case they will cast one combined vote.
f. Members may not vote for the position they are running for.

Section 16. Responsibilities.

a. Both elected and appointed officers shall be responsible for their duties as listed in this constitution.

b. Each officer shall also establish and maintain a working relationship with the General Membership, Executive Board, and all other officers, advisors, chairs, committees, and staff necessary to perform their duties.

Section 17. (This section is mandatory) Officer Transitions.

a. Each officer shall maintain a record of their position, including budgets and activities of the office, to provide to incoming officers following elections.
b. Outgoing officers shall also make every effort to assist in the transition process, including helping to ensure that incoming officers are aware of their responsibilities.

Section 18. Vacancies.

a. Any officer may resign by submitting a letter to the Executive Board.
b. In the event of a position vacancy, the President shall, with the majority approval of the Executive Board, appoint replacement to serve until the next election cycle.
c. A vacancy of the office of President shall be treated as a temporary absence as defined in this Article.
d. Any person selected to fill a vacancy shall meet the eligibility requirements prescribed for that position.
e. Current officers shall be eligible to run for the vacant position but must vacate their original position immediately upon election.

Article VI – Advisor

Section 1. Advisor selection.

a. Any faculty or staff member at Cornell University capable of corresponding with the university in the official and legal matters of the **Cornell Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers**.
b. A majority vote of active members selects Independent organization advisors.
c. University/Department advisors are assigned by the university/department to oversee an organization.

Section 2. <u>Responsibilities of the advisor.</u>

a. Attend general body and/or executive board meetings when needed
b. Meet regularly with the organization's President to stay updated and serve as a resource
c. Assist with the annual registration process
d. Assist with the funding process

Please note additional responsibilities are permitted to be ratified

Section 3. Term of service.

a. There is no limit to how long the advisor may hold the position subject to the advisor acting in the organization's best interests, does not violate any Cornell University Policies

rules and/or Student Code of Conduct, and is not engaged in activity jeopardizing the organization's existence.

Article VII – Meetings (A section regarding meetings is MANDATORY but meeting requirements & expectations are determined by the organization)

Section 1. Officers/Executive board.

a. Hold officer meetings outside the regular meeting schedule as often as necessary, called by the President and/or Vice-President.

Section 2. All members.

a. Hold general meetings regularly as decided by the organization members each semester based on academic obligations.

Section 3. Quorum and Referendum.

a. Four members are the minimum number of voting members who must be present at a properly called meeting to conduct business in the group's name.
b. All Officers must be present to transact business.

Article VIII – Dues

No dues shall be paid by any member.

Article IX – Amendments and Ratification

Section 1. This constitution shall become effective once uploaded to CampusGroups during the annual re-registration process.

Section 2. Ratification process

a. The constitution on file in CampusGroups is uploaded annually during the re-registration process and is valid until amendments are made.
b. This constitution must be ratified again once every academic year and re-uploaded to the CampusGroups group file.
c. The officers will propose any changes to the document before ratification to allow time for organization members to review it.
d. Any member may submit a written proposal to the President or Vice-President to amend anytime during the academic year.
e. Submitted amendments will be voted upon at the next general body meeting.
f. Any change to this constitution approved by a majority of the organization's members voting goes into effect.
g. **Any changes to the constitution must be shared with Campus Activities as a revised constitution for review.**